



PROGRESS REPORT

Lesotho: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-09 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-08.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	The National Digital Transformation Strategy: Agenda 2030 has been in force unamended since 2024, with no review or successor on file. The strategy was launched in 2024 and stands unamended (strategy). No mid-term review, progress report, costing or delivery schedule under it has been published, so the base holds the instrument and no account of what it has moved.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy	The National Digital Policy 2024 remains in force and unamended, sitting alongside the transformation strategy issued the same year. The policy was issued in 2024 and is recorded as in force, unamended (policy). Nothing on file records an implementation plan, a regulator instruction issued under it, or any assessment of its effect.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy	A Broadband Infrastructure Sharing Policy was signed by the communications minister in June 2026, with no implementation instrument on record. The minister signed the policy on 12 June 2026, one of three digital policies signed together (signing). The text itself is not held, so its obligations on licensees cannot be stated. The 2025/26 budget speech had recorded the drafts as validated, and no regulator guidance under the signed policy has been published since (budget speech).	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy	A national data-centre implementation roadmap went into drafting at a six-ministry Maseru workshop in August 2026; no text yet exists. The five-day workshop opened on 17 August 2026, organised by the communications ministry with the United Nations in Lesotho and coordinated by the UN Office for Digital and Emerging Technologies (workshop). The roadmap covers data governance, skills, compute, energy, cooling, financing and implementation choices, and builds on the artificial-intelligence, data-management and broadband policies validated in draft in January 2025 (roadmap). No publication date, custodian or cost is stated, and its relationship to the separately recorded Kobong data centre is not stated.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap	An enterprise architecture and interoperability framework was commissioned in 2024; neither it nor a roadmap has been published. 2024-07-22 — terms of reference commissioned the government enterprise architecture and e-government interoperability framework. 2025-08-26 — the communications ministry opened a two-day workshop to develop a digital public infrastructure framework. Two years on from the commission, no framework document, roadmap or timetable is on the record, and the base carries nothing on what the architecture covers.	ADVANCED commissioned and unpublished
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	A National AI Policy was signed in June 2026 and a separate National AI Strategy went into drafting in August; neither text is held. The government and the United Nations ran a five-day high-level policy and capacity-building workshop on a national artificial-intelligence strategy and a data centre blueprint (workshop). No strategy text is held. The policy was signed by the communications minister on 12 June 2026, covering responsible artificial intelligence in health, education and public administration (signing, account). Its text is not held, so its scope and commitments cannot be stated. A distinct National AI Strategy was being drafted at a Maseru workshop that opened on 17 August 2026, intended as the framework for deployment; the deputy prime minister's keynote asked for capability assessment, safeguards, infrastructure, policy and human capacity to be settled before investment is widened (strategy).	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies	No localisation or residency rule is held; section 52 of the Data Protection Act governs cross-border transfer instead. 2012-02-22 — the Act's section 52 governs cross-border transfer of personal information, the closest enacted instrument to a residency rule. 2025-10-14 — a validation workshop aligned the draft data management policy with the African Union data policy framework. 2026-02-20 — the ministry's ICT director said the policy was on the verge of being finalised, four months before it was signed. No rule requiring government or personal data to be held in Lesotho is on the record.	ADVANCED on a general data policy rather than a residency rule

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	A Data Management Policy was signed in June 2026 as a privacy, security and ethical-use framework, and a data value blueprint is in drafting. The minister signed the Data Management Policy on 12 June 2026 (signing), and its text is not held. Drafting of a National Data Value Creation Blueprint opened at a first national consultative workshop on 14 and 15 July 2026, with no text yet in existence (workshop). The country's membership of the Smart Africa programme behind it rests on a spokesperson's remarks carried by the government news agency.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy	The government's own digital policy records that open government data legislation has yet to be promulgated. 2024-12-30 — the National Digital Policy states Lesotho has yet to promulgate legislation on open government data, the most current statement the base holds. 2025-09-24 — the Prime Minister told a leaders' symposium that Lesotho had adopted a national digital framework and was piloting digital public infrastructure, working with regional and European partners to validate a data governance policy. The absence was searched on 31 August 2026: no portal, no policy, no dataset inventory. A data management policy was signed in June 2026 and is not an open-data instrument.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	The Data Protection Act 2011 remains in force and unamended, on the most recent account held, dated March 2026. The Act has been in force since 2011 and was recorded as unamended as at 23 March 2026 (review). No amendment, regulation or commencement instrument has been published since, and the base holds no enforcement action, complaint count or guidance issued under it.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	The Computer Crime and Cybersecurity Bill was split into a Cybercrime Bill and a Cybersecurity Bill, both awaiting National Assembly approval. Both bills were reported on 29 July 2026 as awaiting National Assembly approval, on no published timetable (forum, account). The Cybersecurity Bill is intended to build the institutions protecting critical digital infrastructure, which is the statute the interim response team now operating was set up ahead of (interim body). No text of either bill is held.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	The National Identity Cards Act 2011 is the founding statute; an electoral Bill now ties voter registration to the identity number. 2011-03-21 — Act 9 of 2011 establishes the National Identity Register and the identity-card regime, commenced in 2013. 2026-06-04 — the Senate adopted its legislation committee's report on the electoral amendment Bill, which ties voter registration and verification to the national identity number. 2026-06-29 — the home affairs ministry opened a workshop on a systems architecture and modernisation framework, setting out the legal and institutional implications of the reforms proposed. No amendment to the 2011 Act is before Parliament.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	The Payment System Bill reached second reading in May 2026, to replace the 2014 Act and license fintech providers. 2014-09-12 — the Payment Systems Act governs payment systems and instruments, electronic money and cards among them. 2025-11-17 — the financial sector strategy sets strengthening the payments system and access to digital financial services as cross-cutting priorities. 2026-05-05 — the finance minister moved the Payment System Bill to second reading, to repeal and replace the 2014 Act and license fintech payment providers. No enactment date is on the record.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability	No dedicated interoperability statute exists; the VAT e-invoicing regulations are the binding data-exchange rule the base holds. 2012-02-22 — the Data Protection Act is the closest enacted instrument bearing on lawful sharing of personal government data. 2026-03-27 — Legal Notice 25 of 2026 requires system-to-system electronic transmission of VAT transaction data, a binding interoperability rule confined to one revenue stream. 2025-08-26 — a workshop opened to develop a digital public infrastructure framework. No statute enabling data exchange across government generally is held.	ADVANCED on a tax regulation rather than a general statute
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations	The government names the AI Policy of 2025 as its governance foundation; no AI Act or regulation exists. 2026-02-20 — the ministry's ICT director reported the national AI policy successfully approved. 2026-07-07 — the Deputy Prime Minister told the UN global dialogue that the policy is the country's AI governance foundation. 2026-07-20 — Lesotho signed the founding agreement of a world AI cooperation organisation in Shanghai, an international commitment ahead of any domestic law. The absence was searched on 31 August 2026. No Bill, no regulations, and no announced timetable for either.	NO CHANGE a policy with no statute behind it
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	The Electronic Transactions and Electronic Communications Bill remains pending promulgation; the movement was in adjacent law. 2024-12-30 — the National Digital Policy records the 2022 Bill as still pending promulgation. 2026-03-27 — electronic invoicing was made mandatory for VAT transactions, a direct digital-commerce compliance rule made while the general statute waits. 2026-05-05 — the Payment System Bill reached second reading. Four years after it was drafted, Lesotho still has no statute recognising electronic transactions generally.	NO CHANGE the Bill still pending
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation	A fourth Statistics Bill is expected to be enacted before the end of 2026, replacing a statute from 2001. 2001 — Act 8 of 2001 establishes the Bureau of Statistics and the national statistical system. 2025-12-12 — a regional peer review recorded a fourth Statistics Bill in drafting and recommended modernising the 2001 Act. 2026-06-27 — bureau officials described the Bill's content and expected enactment before the end of 2026. The Bill text is not held.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation	A 2021 capacity assessment found no access-to-information legislation in force, and nothing since records one being enacted. The assessment carried out for the Millennium Challenge Corporation and the Lesotho Millennium Development Agency found no access-to-information statute in force in September 2021 (assessment). No bill, draft or commitment to one has appeared in the base in the five years since, so the absence is a searched one at that date and an unexamined one after it.	NO CHANGE
Data protection	Data protection authority	The Data Protection Commission is provided for by the 2011 Act but no commissioner had been appointed as at March 2026. The commission exists in law and not in fact: the 2011 Act provides for it, and the most recent account held records no commissioner appointed as at 23 March 2026 (review). Fifteen years after the statute, the base holds no appointment, no budget line, no staff and no supervisory decision from it.	NO CHANGE
Data protection	National data protection readiness	A US\$364m health agreement with the United States carries data-sharing agreements that have not been published, after a brief release was withdrawn. The agreement was signed in December 2025 and stated at US\$364m (complaint). The State Department published a subset of the memoranda in March 2026 and then removed public access, and the related data-sharing agreements have not been published. Lesotho is one of sixteen countries named in a freedom-of-information suit filed on 2 April 2026 that remains unresolved, and African governments had already pushed back on the health deals over data and power (reporting).	REGRESSED the data-sharing instrument behind a bilateral health agreement was briefly published and then withdrawn
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	Lesotho joined the 50-in-5 digital public infrastructure campaign as its fourteenth member in May 2024, and no milestone has been reported since. The country joined in May 2024 as the fourteenth member, with civil registration and its integration with digital public infrastructure named as the commitment (joining, profile). No milestone, review or output under the campaign has been reported for the country in the two years since.	NO CHANGE
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation	An African Union Data Policy Framework readiness workshop was convened in July 2025, and no assessment or resulting instrument is held. AUDA-NEPAD convened a readiness workshop from 28 to 31 July 2025 on domesticating the framework (workshop). No readiness assessment, legislative review or instrument has followed it into the base, so the domestication is recorded as convened and not as done.	NO CHANGE
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	Lesotho is a founding pilot country of the regional settlement system and hosts the regional cyber drill. 2023-11-08 — Lesotho is named one of four founding pilot countries of the regional real-time gross settlement system. 2025-08-25 — a partnership was announced to build a federated regional identity-verification arrangement, on a validated Lesotho-South Africa pilot. 2025-11-04 — Lesotho hosted the sixth regional cyber drill and announced joining the Smart Africa Alliance. A small landlocked economy reaches shared infrastructure it could not build alone; what the base does not hold is any figure for what Lesotho contributes to or draws from it.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers	The only cross-border arrangement on file is the health data-sharing instrument with the United States, whose text is withheld. African governments pushed back during 2026 on United States health agreements over data and power, this country's among them (reporting). The data-sharing agreements attached to its own agreement have not been published, and the base holds no adequacy decision, transfer safeguard or domestic authorisation covering them (complaint).	NO CHANGE
Standards	National interoperability standards	A Government Enterprise Architecture and Interoperability Framework has been under development since the 2025/26 budget, with no further detail published. The budget speech recorded the framework as under development, aimed at improving government efficiency and service delivery and at avoiding fragmented and costly infrastructure deployment across government (budget speech). No draft, adoption date, standards register or list of the systems bound by it has been published in the eighteen months since.	ADVANCED
Standards	National quality standards	Quality-of-service rules have been in force since 2023, and the regulator's own testing puts compliance at 75 per cent with speeds far below target. Legal Notice No. 41 of 2023 came into force on 21 April 2023, prescribing minimum quality-of-service standards for voice, data, postal and courier licensees across accessibility, integrity and retainability, with two published schedules of measurable parameters (rules). The two mobile operators reached 75 per cent overall compliance across twelve general parameters in the year to 31 March 2025, missing on disconnection-complaint resolution time and mobile order-completion time (annual report). Drive-testing across three Maseru clusters in November 2025 found mean download speeds of 2.88 to 2.95 Mbps against a 25 Mb/s target, and unsuccessful call ratios of 2.6 to 6.2 per cent against a 2 per cent ceiling (testing).	MIXED quality-of-service rules in force and measured, with two parameters missed and speeds far below the target
Standards	Adoption of international standards	The standards institution is operational and the identity build runs on an international open-source standard. 2020-09-16 – the trade minister declared the standards institution operational, with a standards-development, testing and certification mandate. 2025-10-14 – a validation workshop aligned the data management policy with the African Union data policy framework. 2026-02-26 – the 2026 work plan continues deployment of an internationally developed open-source digital identity standard. No list of standards adopted, and no conformance regime, is published.	ADVANCED
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	A standing National Cybersecurity Forum was constituted in July 2026, spanning government, industry, regulators, banks and telecommunications providers. The forum held its inaugural meeting on 29 July 2026 and is standing rather than convened for an occasion (launch, account). It is the only structured route on file by which bodies outside government contribute to national digital policy, and no terms of reference, membership list or output from it has been published (report).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	The one public contest on file is an allegation of political interference in regulator appointments, denied by the ministry and unanswered by the regulator. The outgoing chief licensing officer at the communications authority alleged at a media briefing reported on 22 August 2026 that the communications minister pressed the board to re-advertise the post rather than renew the five-year contract that expired on 31 May 2026, and that the universal service fund's executive secretary was removed in the same way (briefing). The minister stated the ministry has no role in recruiting the authority's managers, and the authority declined to comment. It is an allegation with a ministerial denial and no regulator response, and the base holds no inquiry into it.	ADVANCED

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	The 2025/26 budget appropriated M381.1 million to the sector, naming a security operations centre, an interoperability framework and fibre works. The budget speech of 19 February 2025 allocated M381.1 million to the sector and named its intended uses: a Government Security Operations Centre, a Government of Lesotho Enterprise Architecture and Interoperability Framework, a completed fibre feasibility study, 17 operational base tower stations and a 96km fibre stretch from Roma to Thaba-Tseka (budget speech). No outturn, disbursement figure or later appropriation is held, so the base records what was voted and not what was spent.	ADVANCED
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	Smart Africa, the African Union and the German Embassy were named as supporters of the data blueprint work, with no programme document or amount held. The three were named as supporters at the first blueprint workshop in July 2026 (workshop). No terms of reference, programme document or amount is held for any of them, so the base records three named backers and nothing that any of them is committed to.	ADVANCED
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	Project Kobong carries the largest private commitment on file, put by government at M100bn and by the developer at about US\$6.2bn. The government figure was M98bn in June 2026 and M100bn in August (approval, tribunal account); the developer's chief executive states about US\$6.2bn of capital investment, while the developer's own release of 8 June 2026 states no value (release). The commitment rests on a binding memorandum of agreement of 4 June 2026 and is conditional on feasibility, financing, permitting and definitive agreements (memorandum).	ADVANCED
New investments	Development-partner project financing	Partner money carries two named projects: an African Development Bank e-government phase and a UNICEF learning dashboard. The African Development Bank committed US\$13.95m to the second phase of the eGovernment Infrastructure Project in 2019, with US\$16.5m disbursed and the project ending in 2026 (commitment); a Digital Outreach Studio was launched under it in June 2026 (studio). UNICEF and the Global Partnership for Education announced support on 23 July 2026 for a foundational literacy and numeracy dashboard, with tablets for principals in 300 project schools and solar power in 25 cluster learning spaces (support).	ADVANCED

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	The larger operator reports 1.21m customers and 85 per cent market share, and the other has 149 5G sites on 700MHz. The thirtieth-anniversary account of June 2026 gives 1.21m customers, 85 per cent market share, 422 base stations of which 101 are solar, and coverage of 97 per cent on 2G, 98 per cent on 3G and 96 per cent on 4G (account). A US\$40m phased network upgrade was announced in March 2026 (upgrade), following an upgrade pledged at the group chief executive's visit in August 2025 (visit). The second operator grew its 5G sites from 54 to 149 on 700MHz by June 2025, and no later figure is held (5G, network).	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet usage	The ministry puts broadband coverage at 100 per cent against about 50 per cent regular internet use, a gap no programme on file addresses directly. The communications ministry stated the two figures at the United Nations Global Dialogue on AI Governance in July 2026 (statement). No earlier measurement is held, so the level is recorded and the direction is not. The one product launched into that gap is a fixed-mobile convergence service, live since July 2025 with nothing later on record (service).	NO CHANGE a first statement of the gap with no earlier figure behind it
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	The regulator found against an operator over unnotified airtime restrictions and ordered them reversed; no price series is published. 2020-02 — a World Bank diagnostic is the base's fullest account of digital infrastructure and affordability. 2025-10-01 — an operator published promotional bundle terms. 2025-12-05 — the regulator found against an operator over airtime restrictions applied without notice and ordered them reversed. No basket price, income share or affordability index for Lesotho is held, which is what this indicator turns on.	ADVANCED on enforcement rather than price
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	A metropolitan fibre network has a completed feasibility study and no construction reported; a 96km Roma to Thaba-Tseka stretch was under way in 2025. The budget speech of February 2025 recorded the feasibility study for the Lesotho Metropolitan Fibre Distribution Network as completed, laying groundwork for high-speed broadband across the major towns, with construction not reported (feasibility). The same speech recorded a 96km fibre stretch from Roma to Thaba-Tseka under way and 17 base tower stations operational (budget speech). Eighteen months on, no completion, route map or capacity figure has been published for either.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	A managed satellite enterprise service launched in August 2026, the first international path not transiting a neighbour. 2018-02-13 — the regulator's sector review describes the international gateways and bandwidth pricing structure. 2026-07-01 — the regulator's strategic plan makes universal and meaningful connectivity its top theme. 2026-08-26 — the incumbent operator launched managed satellite enterprise connectivity. Lesotho is landlocked and every terrestrial route crosses South Africa. No capacity figure in gigabits, and no wholesale price, is published.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points	The exchange was relaunched after a revamp in February 2026, with a refreshed registry record in May. 2011 — the regulator's annual report covers the exchange's founding period and the regional cable completion. 2026-02-02 — the Internet Society chapter relaunched the revamped exchange. 2026-05-13 — a refreshed registry record gives a later externally visible snapshot. No peer count, traffic figure or capacity for the exchange is published.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	A ten-year satellite licence was granted in April 2025 over local-shareholding objections, and the service is live through a sole reseller. The communications authority granted a ten-year licence on 14 April 2025, contested over full foreign ownership: the incumbent appealed for local shareholding and a rights group objected (licence, objection). Nothing later on record resolves the objection. The service launched through T-Connect as exclusive reseller on 30 June 2025 (launch, account), and by January 2026 was reported also carried over the incumbent's low-earth-orbit backhaul (backhaul).	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	Project Kobong was approved in July 2026 as a green-powered artificial-intelligence data centre at Mokhotlong, with construction targeted for 2029. The project was approved and launched at a ceremony hosted by the United States Embassy on 31 July 2026, on a binding memorandum covering pumped storage and a data centre at Mokhotlong, conditional on feasibility, financing, permitting and definitive agreements (approval, partnership). Construction is targeted for 2029 (account, first data centre). The base holds no operating commercial data-centre capacity in the country at all, so the whole of this indicator is a project not due to break ground for three years.	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)	The incumbent operator runs two commercial data centres; the state's own hosting is still in build. 2026-08-29 — the operator names two facilities, at Maseru West and Lekokoaneng, the strongest current self-description held. 2025-08-01 — the regulator opened procurement for disaster-recovery IT equipment. 2026-05-07 — the minister raised a high-performance computing upgrade and pitched data-centre investment at the United Nations. No floor space, rack count or power figure is published for any facility in Lesotho.	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity	A Tier III government data centre at Mohale's Hoek, designed as a 100km-separated backup to the Maseru facility, was near-complete in 2018 and unconfirmed since. The facility was toured near-complete by the communications minister in May 2018 under the e-Government Infrastructure Project, awaiting its power station, and designed as a backup separated by 100km from the finance ministry's Maseru data centre (tour). No source later than that tour confirms the power station's completion or the facility going live, so eight years on the country's only recorded off-site backup is of unknown status.	STALLED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres	Generation runs at about 72MW against about 209MW of demand, while Kobong plans at least 1,200MW of pumped storage for its data centre. About 72MW is installed against about 209MW of domestic demand, and 438 of the 970 GWh consumed in 2024 were imported (generation). The Kobong memorandum covers at least 1,200MW of pumped storage alongside a green-powered data centre, conditional on feasibility and financing and with construction targeted for 2029 (approval). No water assessment for the site is held, and no statement connects the new generation to the existing national deficit.	MIXED a national generation deficit against a dedicated pumped-storage scheme planned for the data centre
Energy	Grid reliability	The utility reports more than 99% availability on transmission and around 95% on distribution, held over recent years. 2026-08-29 – the electricity corporation states it has maintained availability above 99% on the transmission network and around 95% on distribution for the past years, attributing faults to an ageing network and weather. 2026-05-27 – a \$50m credit was approved combining grid expansion with utility-reform technical assistance. 2026-03-01 – the first quarterly progress report against the energy compact's reform commitments was published. The availability figures are the utility's own and the base holds nothing testing them. No outage-duration or interruption-frequency figure is published.	NO CHANGE on the utility's own figures
Energy	Rural electrification	National access stood at 53% in July 2025 – 303,074 households on the grid and 840 on mini-grids of 569,631 in all. 2025-07-01 – the energy compact records 303,074 households electrified through grid extension and 840 through mini-grids, of 569,631 households in total, leaving 47% without access, against a universal-access target for 2030. 2025-08-04 – a grid extension launched to electrify four remote villages in Thaba-Tseka. 2026-05-27 – a \$50m credit was approved for grid expansion in peri-urban, rural and highland areas with off-grid solar. The compact publishes a national rate and household counts; no separate rural rate is stated, so the gap between the settled lowlands and the highlands cannot be read from the base.	ADVANCED
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	Government ICT was assessed as fragmented with low cybersecurity preparedness in 2023; no later assessment is held. Terms of reference were published for a project manager to lead the upgrade of the integrated financial management information system to a current platform version (terms of reference). A hiring notice is the earliest stage of a build. 2023-03-06 – a project appraisal assessed government ICT as fragmented, with low cybersecurity preparedness. 2026-02-26 – the 2026 work plan continues building the identity platform, the one part of the estate with funded work behind it. The assessment is three years old and nothing has re-tested it. No uptime figure, asset register or refresh cycle for government systems is published.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems	Government appointed its first chief information security officer and announced a plan to move ICT services out of the civil service into a separate agency. The first chief information security officer across government was reported appointed on 29 July 2026 (appointment, account). A separate government ICT agency was announced the same day, to take ICT services out of the civil service, with no enabling instrument, scope or date published (agency). Both are institutional rather than measured: the base holds no count of technical staff in government, no maintenance arrangement and no assessment of what the state can run without a vendor.	ADVANCED
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	An interim national response team launched in July 2026 and a security operations centre is being stood up, against no national strategy at the last review. LesComCSIRT launched in Maseru on 29 July 2026 and operates on an interim basis, ahead of the statute intended to establish it (launch, account). A national security operations centre was reported being stood up the same month, having been budgeted as a Government Security Operations Centre in the 2025/26 budget speech; no host, operator or date is published (centre, budget). A capacity maturity review of March 2023 rated the strategy dimension at start-up and confirmed no official national cybersecurity strategy, and none has been published since (review).	ADVANCED

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	X-Road was presented in February 2026 as one of three systems under development, with no go-live date published. The interoperability platform was presented at a joint ministry and university review of digital public infrastructure progress on 20 February 2026 (review). Once-only information exchange had been named a priority of the year in the memorandum with India signed in July 2025, with no platform then on record (memorandum). No go-live date, connected agency or transaction figure has been published.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems	The identity number is used for customer verification by banks, insurers and mobile operators, and a cross-border use is proposed. 2011-03-21 – the founding Act provides for third-party access to the register, the legal basis for other-system use. 2025-11-17 – the financial sector strategy records the identity number in use by the credit bureau, banks, insurers and mobile network operators for customer verification. 2026-02-26 – the 2026 work plan formalises cross-sector identity verification on the open-source platform. 2026-04-22 – use of the identity card as a travel document at the South African border was proposed, with no agreement on the record. No count of systems consuming the identifier, and no authentication volume, is published.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems	A consultancy is integrating donor-project systems with the national DHIS2 platform. 2026-04-09 – the World Health Organization records the endorsed national digital health strategy and names digital transformation a priority. 2026-04-01 – a workshop called for interoperability among the identity, civil registration, education and health databases. 2026-06-19 – a consultancy was commissioned to integrate project systems with the national DHIS2 platform. The integration on the record is of a donor project into the national platform, not of national systems with each other. No health information exchange is held.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems	The education management system is rolling out on the DHIS2 platform, with a teacher system developed separately. 2026-05-11 – the education management information system is rolling out on the DHIS2 platform, the same platform the health sector uses. 2026-04-01 – a teacher management information system is being developed, informed by a peer exchange with Zambia, a workstream distinct from the education system. Two education systems are being built on separate tracks and the base holds nothing on their connecting to each other or to the identity layer.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems	Digital birth registration feeds the social registry, with a district data refresh run from December 2025. 2025-06-19 – digital birth registration under the child programme is integrated with the social registry, the base's clearest evidence of two national registries exchanging data. 2025-11-12 – a registry data-refresh exercise ran from December 2025 to March 2026. 2026-02-26 – the identity work plan references alignment with the second national social protection strategy. No data-sharing agreement or technical specification for the linkage is published.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	The National Identification System is in operation, and the most recent account held of it is a case study published in 2022. The system is recorded as in operation, documented in a World Bank GovTech case study of 2022 and in the same institution's service-delivery study of that year (case study, service delivery). No later coverage, enrolment or performance figure is held, and the independent research on digital identity in the country dates from 2021 (research).	NO CHANGE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	The identity register covered roughly 85% of the eligible population in 2022; no later figure is published. 2022-05 – an assessment put coverage at an estimated 85 per cent of the eligible population, a little over a million people of a total 1.2 million. 2026-02-26 – a 2026 commitment was made to an integrated digital identity system. 2026-06-29 – a modernisation framework consultation opened at the home affairs ministry. The coverage figure is four years old and both movements since are about the platform rather than enrolment. No later count is published.	NO CHANGE on a four-year-old coverage figure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems	A 2026 work plan with UNICEF commits to a MOSIP-based national identity platform covering passport and identity renewal and proof-of-life verification. The work plan was signed by the ministry and UNICEF on 3 March 2026, covering passport and identity renewal, biometric registration and proof-of-life verification on a MOSIP base (work plan). Digital identity pilots had begun under the memorandum with India, with no platform then named (memorandum), and the systems under development were reviewed with the national university in February 2026 (review). No procurement, vendor or go-live date is published.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	A digital service-ID pilot of about 10,000 participants began in April 2026, requiring a national identity document, a registered SIM and biometric registration. The pilot was announced on 25 March 2026 to begin on 2 April with about 10,000 participants in a testing phase (pilot). Registration requires a valid national identity document, a registered SIM card and biometric registration. No vendor, legal basis or evaluation criteria is stated, and no result from the pilot has been published.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth	A unique personal identification number is issued on birth registration, with a scale-up roadmap to 2030. 2011-03-21 — the founding Act provides for a unique identity number at registration, including for children entered through a parent or guardian. 2026-07-18 — the registry's own presentation states a unique personal identification number is issued on birth registration, with a nationwide scale-up roadmap running to 2030. 2026-04-01 — a proposal was put to use maternal health records to trigger earlier birth registration. No birth-registration completeness figure is published, so how many children the number actually reaches cannot be stated.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id	The registry runs an integrated civil registration and identity architecture, now under a modernisation framework. 2022-05 — an assessment documents the integrated civil registration and national identity architecture and the interoperability gaps left in it. 2026-02-26 — the 2026 work plan frames civil registration and digital identity development together. 2026-06-29 — a stakeholder consultation opened on a systems architecture and modernisation framework covering both. The architecture is integrated on paper and the gaps named in 2022 have not been reported closed.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems	The identity number is in use for customer verification across the financial sector, and cross-sector authentication is being formalised. 2025-11-17 — the financial sector strategy is the most current statement of the identity number's linkage to the credit bureau, banks, insurers and mobile network operators. 2026-02-26 — the 2026 work plan formalises cross-sector authentication and financial-services identity verification. 2025-08-26 — a framework workshop set out identity-verified access to services, the earliest in-window statement of the design. What the base does not hold is a transaction figure: how often the identity is actually checked, by whom, and at what cost to the relying party.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The central bank's national payment switch has localised instant payments, ATM and point-of-sale transactions across four commercial banks. LeSwitch carries instant payments from 2022, ATM localisation from October 2024 and point-of-sale localisation from 11 May 2025, across four commercial banks (point of sale, central bank, switch). E-commerce and retail were named as the next steps and nothing later is held, so the switch's coverage is recorded as at May 2025.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	The only government-to-person channel on file carries 20,000 Child Grants Programme beneficiaries on digital grant payments. Digital grant payments to 20,000 beneficiaries of the Child Grants Programme were in operation when the digital birth registration programme launched in April 2025 (programme). No later enrolment figure, payment volume or extension to another transfer is held, and no other government payment stream is recorded as digital.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	Tax e-payment integration went live in February 2026 for company tax, pay-as-you-earn, value-added tax and customs duties. Revenue Services Lesotho and Standard Lesotho Bank launched the integration on 11 February 2026, reachable over USSD, internet banking and the bank's mobile application (launch). No collection figure, share of receipts taken electronically, or extension to a second bank has been published since.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality	The national e-invoicing platform is rolling out with business-to-business and business-to-government invoicing. 2023-03-14 – the revenue authority launched its e-payment and e-taxation platform, the operative business-to-government rail. 2026-02-10 – a payment gateway with a commercial bank went live for tax settlement. 2026-08-12 – the national e-invoicing platform is rolling out nationwide, carrying business-to-business and business-to-government invoicing. No transaction volume or value is published for any of the three.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	A wallet investment service launched in July 2026 over USSD, from M50 for individual customers and M300 for group-savings customers. Tsetela launched in Maseru on 22 July 2026 over a USSD short code, from M50 for individual mobile-money customers and M300 for group-savings customers, with the asset manager licensed by the Central Bank of Lesotho (launch, account). It is the first investment product reachable from a wallet on record (report), and no subscriber or value figure has been published since (coverage). The dominant operator launched an electronic top-up service that drops physical vouchers, with top-ups from M1.50. No uptake figure, agent-network effect or regulator position is held, and the minimum top-up is the only price stated.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	Mobile money was spun into a separately constituted entity with 14,000 agents, while the second wallet has been unchanged since 2024. The mobile money business was spun off into VCL Financial Services on 13 March 2026 (spin-off) and reported 14,000 agents by June 2026 (anniversary). EcoCash completed a platform migration in October 2024 with group savings, payroll and fraud detection integrated, and wallet interest payouts stated as forthcoming; nothing later is held (migration). No account or active-user figure is published for either.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	Renminbi settlement became available through a commercial bank in July 2026, while migrant workers moved to fintechs as South African rules tightened. Standard Bank extended access to China's cross-border interbank payment system beyond South Africa to five markets including Lesotho, reported on 27 July 2026 (access). Migrant workers remitting from South Africa moved from banks to fintechs as South African remittance and banking rules tightened, reported in June 2026 (remittances). No corridor volume, price or regional switch connection is published.	MIXED a new renminbi settlement route against migrant workers pushed out of bank channels
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection	Three implementing regulations under the consumer protection Act reached Senate adoption in May 2026. 2022-06-03 — the Financial Consumer Protection Act establishes the regime and the central bank's powers under it. 2026-05-07 — three implementing regulations reached Senate adoption, four years after the Act. 2026-05-05 — the Payment System Bill would license fintech providers under one law. No complaints figure, redress statistic or dispute-resolution route for payment users is published.	ADVANCED
Registries	Population register	The National Identity Register is established by the 2011 Act; the movement is a modernisation framework, not enrolment. 2011-03-21 — section 3 of the Act establishes the register itself. 2026-02-26 — the 2026 work plan ties open-source platform development to the register. 2026-06-29 — a consultation opened on a systems architecture design and modernisation framework for the registry. No registered-population figure later than 2022, no deduplication rate and no register-quality measure is published.	ADVANCED on the platform rather than the register
Registries	Civil register	Digital birth registration has been in operation since April 2025 under a programme run with the European Union and UNICEF, with no later enrolment figure. The programme launched on 2 April 2025 with the European Union and UNICEF (launch). No registration count, coverage share or link to the national identification system has been published since, so the base records that the registration is digital and not how much of the population it reaches.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Address register	No state address register exists; a private nationwide platform launched in May 2026. 2011-02-24 — the land regulations carry the allocation and identification registers, the closest operative instrument to an address register. 2026-05-08 — officials proposed a national spatial development infrastructure policy, stating that no spatial-data policy currently exists. 2026-05-22 — a private nationwide digital-address platform launched, filling the gap the officials had described a fortnight earlier. The addressing layer a state usually owns is in private hands here, and the base holds no arrangement governing that.	MIXED a private platform where the state has none

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Business register	A single window is in development at the one-stop business facilitation centre, and registration fees were waived for small firms. 2011-09-02 — the Companies Act establishes the Registrar of Companies and the incorporation regime. 2025-11-20 — a competitiveness project confirms a business facilitation single window to simplify registration and licensing. 2026-05-07 — the Senate backed a registration and licensing fee waiver for micro, small and medium enterprises, already yielding new registrations. No count of registered companies, and no processing time, is published.	ADVANCED
Registries	Social protection register	NISSA holds data on more than 90 per cent of households and has a child-centred redesign piloted in one district. The registry holds data on more than 90 per cent of households, categorised by vulnerability, and a child-centred redesign was piloted in Mafeteng District under the Universal DPI Safeguards Framework (redesign). The registry and its companion management information system were procured together in 2024 (procurement). No update to the coverage figure and no evaluation of the redesign is held.	ADVANCED
Registries	Electoral register	A voter registration strategy was formally endorsed in June 2026, with constituency readiness assessments under way. 2013 — the electoral commission's report describes the constitutional mandate for the general register of electors and the 2011 electoral Act. 2026-06-15 — constituency readiness assessments began ahead of registration intensification, with a commissioner deployment framework covering register audits. 2026-06-25 — the commission, government and international partners formally endorsed the voter registration strategy. 2026-06-04 — a Bill before the Senate would tie registration and verification to the national identity number. No registered-elector count is published.	ADVANCED
Registries	Tax register	The taxpayer register is now fed by mandatory structured electronic transaction data. 2001 — section 7(1) of the Revenue Authority Act authorises systems for taxpayer identification. 2026-03-27 — the e-invoicing regulations legally establish structured electronic transaction data in taxpayer records. 2026-02-10 — a bank payment gateway with automatic reconciliation went live. No registered-taxpayer count is published.	ADVANCED
Registries	Land register	The land authority is taking register services into the districts, with new offices planned. 2010-06-15 — the Land Administration Authority Act charges the authority with maintaining a complete land-holding database. 2025-08-05 — district outreach expanded access to register services, with new district offices planned. 2025-08-27 — the authority put its 2026-2029 strategic plan out to tender, prioritising technology adoption for registration services. No parcel count, coverage figure or registration time is published.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Health	A consultancy was advertised in August 2026 to strengthen the national AIDS commission's capacity to coordinate monitoring and evaluation reporting. The tender was advertised on 16 August 2026 (advertisement). It is a tender rather than an award, and no value, duration or reporting system is named. The base holds no health management information system for the country, so the only health-data movement on record is a request for help coordinating reporting.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Education	A foundational literacy and numeracy dashboard is under construction for Grades 1 to 3, with tablets for principals in 300 project schools. UNICEF and the Global Partnership for Education announced support on 23 July 2026 for the dashboard, covering Grades 1 to 3, with tablets for principals in 300 project schools and solar power in 25 cluster learning spaces (support). No go-live date, data source or coverage beyond the project schools is published, and no wider education management information system is held for the country.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection	The MISSA social-assistance management information system was put to tender in 2024, and no award or delivery is on record. The request for proposals closed on 12 August 2024, and nothing since records an award, a contract or a delivery (procurement). An earlier management information system was built between November 2014 and January 2016, so the country has had one and does not now have a recorded successor.	STALLED
Sectoral management information systems	Justice	The needs assessment for an automated case management system was still in progress in 2023; nothing later is held. 2023-02-01 — the Chief Justice reported the needs assessment for an automated case management system still in progress, the latest statement the base holds. 2026-04-20 — a crime-reporting platform launched nationally, with a police digital transformation policy and strategy alongside it, the clearest movement in the police-to-justice chain. 2026-05-18 — the law and justice ministry hosted a regional conference on digital transformation of intellectual property offices. The courts themselves have no case management system on the record, and the reporting end of the chain has moved while the adjudicating end has not.	NO CHANGE an assessment three years old
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	The e-taxation platform gained bank payment integration and mandatory electronic invoicing inside the window. 2025-02-06 — the revenue authority published its operational guide to the e-taxation platform, the tax-sector system itself. 2026-02-10 — a payment gateway with a commercial bank went live with automatic reconciliation. 2026-03-27 — electronic invoicing was made mandatory, putting structured transaction data into the system. No filing rate, collection figure or system availability is published.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	ASYCUDAWorld has run at all commercial borders since 2015/16; a smart one-stop border post is now in build. 2016-07-27 — the customs system was piloted in 2014/15 and reached all commercial borders in 2015/16. 2026-03-30 — a project supervision report covers the customs and trade facilitation component and the smart one-stop border post. 2026-05-13 — a mission reviewed customs administration and border post progress. No clearance time, declaration volume or revenue figure is published.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Land	The land authority runs an integrated geographic information system, now reaching into the districts. 2021-11-10 — the authority's geographic information system, built to manage all land records, was recognised by a regional award. 2025-08-05 — district outreach carried register services closer to communities. 2026-05-08 — officials proposed a national spatial data policy, stating none currently exists, which is the policy layer the land system has been running without. No performance or coverage figure for the system is published.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	An e-Parliament system was completed, a digital outreach studio opened, and a decision support system is under development. The 2025/26 budget speech reported the e-Parliament system implemented, described as a milestone in modernising legislative processes, with no further detail published (budget speech). A Digital Outreach Studio was launched in June 2026 under the second phase of the eGovernment Infrastructure Project (studio). A decision support system for planning and budgeting was presented as under development in February 2026, with no scope, host or date published (review).	ADVANCED

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government	Digital ambassadors have been deployed across local councils for internet access and computer-literacy training. 2018-01-04 — the ministry connected its first community council, with a stated plan to reach all of them. 2025-11-05 — a social registry update ran across five community councils in Leribe. 2026-04-01 — digital ambassadors were reported deployed across local councils for internet access and computer-literacy training. Eight years after the plan to connect every council, the base holds no count of how many are connected.	ADVANCED
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records	A construction permit system is live at the capital's city council, taking applications, documents, staged review and permit issue online. The Maseru City Council construction permit automation system is live, providing online application, document upload, staged review, message and email notifications, auto-generated invoices and digital permit issue (system). It was built by a Lesotho firm with a Kenyan partner under World Bank private-sector competitiveness funding. No permit volume, processing time or extension to a second council is published.	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics	A trial across 103 rural villages found village health workers on mobile decision support outperformed facility referral. 2026-04-09 — the World Health Organization names DHIS2 and digital transformation among health priorities, the most current status statement held. 2026-02-12 — a cluster-randomised trial across 103 rural villages found community health workers using mobile decision support outperformed facility referral for hypertension care. The evidence here is outcome evidence, which is rare in this frame; what it does not establish is how many clinics run any digital system, a figure the base does not hold.	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools	A school and clinic connectivity programme opened at a Butha-Buthe school in January 2026, after community hotspots in three rural places. T-Connect Impact launched at Soofia International School in Butha-Buthe on 17 January 2026 (launch). It followed the first community hotspots handed over at Matsieng, Thaba Bosiu and Mokhotlong in September 2025 (hotspots). No count of connected schools is published, no clinic is named, and no national programme for rural school connectivity is held.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices	Thirty SMS-based birth registration stations were established across three districts in August 2026. A national farmers portal was launched, placing every farmer in a single digital registry (launch). No enrolment figure is stated. 2022-05 — an assessment sets out the registry's use cases and coverage. 2026-08-05 — thirty birth registration stations were established in government and church health facilities across Maseru, Berea and Leribe, on a low-technology SMS platform. 2026-02-26 — the 2026 work plan continues the identity infrastructure behind them. The capture point chosen is the health facility rather than the registry office, and the platform is SMS rather than a terminal. No count of registry offices with a digital system is published.	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations	A crime-reporting platform launched nationally in April 2026, with station equipment and connectivity following. 2026-04-20 — the crime-reporting platform, in development since 2019, launched nationally alongside a police digital transformation policy and strategy. 2026-06-12 — twenty desktop computers were handed to the police service for selected stations. 2026-07-31 — the universal service fund opened procurement for Wi-Fi and network equipment at police stations across all ten districts. The reporting app reached the public before the stations received computers or connectivity, and the base holds no count of stations with either.	ADVANCED

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	The AI Policy of 2025 is the stated foundation; the one named tool is a planned chatbot for farmers. 2025-10-30 — the ministry's principal secretary described a planned government chatbot for farmers, with an implementation plan for 2026. 2026-06-11 — digital policies were signed at a ceremony that also confirmed the innovation studio operational. 2026-07-07 — the government told the UN global dialogue that the 2025 policy is its AI governance foundation. No AI system is described as running in government administration. The base holds a policy, a plan and a pilot.	ADVANCED at policy and pilot stage
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems	Computer-aided screening is in use in tuberculosis case-finding, the one production system the base holds. 2025-06-04 — a peer-reviewed study confirms computer-aided chest X-ray screening operating in tuberculosis case-finding. 2026-05-11 — the agricultural research department was validating content for an extension chatbot ahead of a pilot. 2025-12-12 — an academic proposal was published for a Lesotho-specific health diagnostic model. The screening tool is a donor-supplied clinical device rather than a component of a national system; no sectoral management information system is described as using AI.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	A Sesotho word bank is being compiled to train locally relevant AI systems. 2025-01-21 — a 73-page draft implementation plan sits behind the AI policy; the plan itself is not published. 2026-02-18 — the ministry, a development agency and the national university are compiling a Sesotho word bank to train locally relevant AI systems. A language resource is the foundation a small-language country needs before anything else can be built locally. No model, dataset licence or compute arrangement is on the record.	ADVANCED
AI	Control of AI abuse	The Data Protection Act is the strongest legal safeguard reaching AI-processed personal data; the cyber law is still a Bill. 2025-08-31 — a government press statement warned the public about AI-generated deepfakes impersonating the King and the Prime Minister, naming the absent cyber law as the enforcement gap. 2026-01-13 — a meeting between the ministry and the regulator linked AI-enabled cyber threats to the stalled Cybersecurity Bill. 2012-02-22 — the Data Protection Act is the binding statute reaching AI-processed personal data. The head of state has been impersonated and the government said in its own statement that it lacked the law to act. That Bill was still awaiting approval a year later.	ADVANCED on warnings rather than powers
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	A Lesotho firm built the capital's permit system with a Kenyan partner, and two local firms hosted an executive cloud and security workshop. Computer Business Solutions of Lesotho built the Maseru City Council permit system with Web Masters of Kenya under World Bank funding (system). The same firm and DNS Technologies hosted an executive workshop in Maseru on 30 May 2026 on ransomware, cloud security, data sovereignty and immutable backup (workshop). Those are the only two records of domestic technology production or service capability in the base.	ADVANCED
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	The innovation studio is operational with a second under way, alongside two incubation programmes. 2026-06-11 — the studio at the polytechnic was confirmed operational and ground was broken for a second. 2026-03-20 — an entrepreneurship hub opened its fifth incubation cycle with sixty enterprises selected. 2025-10-29 — the first software factory cohort graduated, eight in number. Three hubs are running and none publishes a survival, funding or employment figure for what leaves them.	ADVANCED
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	A UNDP and Econet memorandum was renewed in July 2026 across three pillars, one of them small-business digital entrepreneurship. The memorandum was signed at Maseru on 28 July 2026, renewing a partnership first signed in 2020 and amended in 2022 (signing, account). Its three pillars are digital transformation, connectivity and artificial intelligence; support for innovation; and digital entrepreneurship among micro, small and medium enterprises. No amount, term or deliverable is stated, and no count of new firms or of firms reached is held.	ADVANCED

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	Ministry-level platform training and a geospatial application course for roads engineers ran on top of the standing course list. 2025-02-19 — the public service ministry lists its courses for public-sector digital skills. 2025-11-06 — a service-delivery project funded capacity building for digital administrative platforms across key ministries. 2026-04-22 — roads directorate engineers and technicians were trained on project management and an offline-capable geospatial mobile application. No civil servants trained, pass rate or coverage of the establishment is published.	ADVANCED
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	Government digital-literacy training was reported running across all ten districts in July 2026, with no participant numbers published. The training was reported running in every district on 29 July 2026 (forum, account). No participant count, curriculum, duration or completion figure has been published (report), so the base records national reach and no measure of what it delivers.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education	AI literacy content entered the digital skills learning labs, several of whose ambassadors are teachers. 2024-12-30 — the National Digital Policy is the standing statement on digital-skills frameworks for schools. 2025-11-13 — an education improvement project opened procurement for 500 laptops with mandatory ICT-skills training attached. 2026-03-30 — AI literacy content reached the digital skills learning labs and digital ambassadors, several of them teachers. The training on the record reaches teachers and labs rather than a secondary curriculum, and no curriculum change is held.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	A National AI Academy is proposed in a signed memorandum, with no timetable, governance, curriculum or host institution named. The academy was named in the memorandum signed by UNDP and Econet on 28 July 2026 (memorandum, signing). No timetable, governance structure, curriculum or host institution is named, and the base holds no existing university department, qualification or facility in these subjects for the country.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	An AI skills programme began in June 2026, reported as the country's first, while a corporate training pledge has delivered nothing in twelve months. The AI Skills Development Programme launched with the United States Embassy under the Sebatatso initiative on 17 June 2026, reported as the country's first digital-entrepreneurship and artificial-intelligence tools training (programme). Digital-skills training pledged by a mobile group and a cloud provider at the group chief executive's visit in August 2025 has nothing on record delivered in the twelve months since (pledge). No participant, completion or placement figure is published for either.	MIXED a first artificial-intelligence skills programme running against a corporate training pledge undelivered a year on
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy	One joint review of digital public infrastructure with the national university's mathematics and computer science department is the whole of the record. The ministry and the National University of Lesotho reviewed digital public infrastructure progress together on 20 February 2026 (review). No research programme, funding, publication or output has followed it into the base, and no other academic body or think tank is recorded contributing to digital policy.	NO CHANGE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals	The crime-reporting app launched as a zero-rated feedback channel, alongside the standing contact centre. 2022-05-17 — the National Contact Centre opened as the citizen feedback mechanism. 2025-10-24 — the Ombudsman opened procurement for an electronic case management system to replace manual complaint recording. 2026-04-20 — the crime and violence reporting app launched nationally as a zero-rated channel. None of the three publishes a volume, response time or resolution figure.	ADVANCED
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy	A public survey of digital services experience opened in August 2026 covering access, usability, trust and skills gaps. The survey opened on 9 August 2026, run by the ministry with the United Nations development programme as part of a donor-backed digital readiness assessment, and covers online applications, digital payments and health and education platforms (survey). No closing date, sample target or commitment to publish the results is stated, so the base records that citizens were asked and not that the answers will be seen.	ADVANCED
Access to services	Gender equity	A dedicated women in digital forum was held in April 2026; no gender gap figure is published. 2024-12-30 — the National Digital Policy is the overarching statement. 2025-11-20 — the minister described a community inclusion model whose digital ambassador approach targets women. 2026-04-20 — a dedicated women in digital forum ran on the Commonwealth digital roadshow. No sex-disaggregated figure for phone ownership, internet use or digital skills in Lesotho is held, which is what this indicator turns on.	ADVANCED on convening rather than measurement
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities	An accessible digital library and insight centre was announced in March 2026, under a statute in force since 2021. 2021-03-12 — the Persons with Disability Equity Act establishes the advisory council and accessible-communication duties. 2025-10-15 — the UN resident coordinator called for accessible technology investment at the country's first disability accessibility conference. 2026-03-16 — a memorandum with the incumbent operator announced a 4G-enabled digital library and insight centre carrying assistive technologies. Five years after the Act, the base holds no accessibility standard for public digital services and no compliance assessment against the statute's communication duties.	ADVANCED
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs	Biometric registration for refugees has run since 2018 on a separate system, with no stated pathway into the mainstream one. 2018-10-11 — a biometric registration system for refugees and forcibly displaced people was handed to government. 2026-02-26 — the 2026 identity work plan advances the mainstream platform and states no refugee or displaced-person inclusion pathway. Two identity systems run in parallel and the newer one is being built without a route from the older. No count of registered refugees is published.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	245 of more than 1,800 mapped schools are connected, and the community inclusion model passed to the universal service fund. 2025-11-19 — a ministerial statement reports 245 of more than 1,800 mapped schools connected under the schools connectivity programme, alongside universal-fund community digital centres. 2025-11-20 — the community digital inclusion model moved from a development-agency pilot to full universal service fund management. 2026-07-01 — the regulator's three-year plan makes universal and meaningful connectivity its top theme. The ministry put broadband coverage at 100% against about 50% regular internet use, so the divide these programmes address is one of use rather than reach.	ADVANCED

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics	The strategy covering 2022/23 to 2026/27 is in force and was peer-reviewed for the first time. 2026-08-29 — the Bureau of Statistics lists the strategy for 2022/23 to 2026/27 alongside the 2001 Act as its current framework. 2025-12-12 — the first independent peer review of the national statistical system assessed the strategy and recommended legal and coordination reforms, the fourth Statistics Bill among them. 2026-02-27 — an EU-funded initiative launched to strengthen the Bureau's institutional framework and system coordination. The strategy runs out in 2026/27 and no successor is on the record.	ADVANCED
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	The seventh census was enumerated by June 2026 and is in analysis; the 2016 round is still the last with published results. 2018 — the 2016 census summary is the most recent completed round with published results. 2026-03-13 — 2,750 tablets and 1,045 power banks were delivered for the first fully digital census. 2026-06-05 — nationwide enumeration for the seventh census was completed and moved to analysis. Ten years separate the last published census from the one now in analysis, and no publication date for the new results is on the record.	ADVANCED
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	Vital statistics are produced from civil registration records; the peer review flagged integration gaps. 2024 — the fourth vital statistics report was produced from home affairs civil-registration records for the 2022 reference year. 2025-12-12 — the peer review confirms administrative data in use across health, education and civil registration, and flags integration gaps and legal constraints. 2026-02-26 — the 2026 work plan strengthens the identity and civil-registration infrastructure underneath. The legal constraints the review names are the same ones the fourth Statistics Bill is meant to lift, and that Bill is not yet enacted.	ADVANCED
Open data	Use of open data	A 2021 assessment found no active government open-data programme and no portal, and nothing since records one. The capacity assessment of September 2021 found no government open-data activity (assessment). A civil-society open data initiative launched in 2019, and the country ranked 151st of 187 in the 2020 Open Data Inventory. No government portal, dataset catalogue or publication commitment has appeared in the base in the five years since.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data	A public land cover dashboard launched in March 2026, built on the operational national mapping system. 2022-07-08 — an operational satellite land-cover and cropland mapping system was built for the catchment programme and official statistics. 2026-03-02 — a public-facing land cover dashboard launched, naming farmers among its intended users. 2026-06-25 — the June food security outlook draws on satellite rainfall and remote-sensing indicators for crop-condition and drought assessment. No figure for use of the dashboard, or for advisory services reaching farmers from it, is published.	ADVANCED
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data	A nowcasting system integrating satellite data with observations was set up in 2026, over a network described as fragmented. 2011-07-19 — regional forecasting arrangements put satellite products into the cascading framework the national service works within. 2025-09-29 — technical assistance opened to modernise a meteorological network of more than ninety stations and the multi-hazard early-warning systems on it. 2026-04-08 — a nowcasting system integrating satellite data with observations and model output was set up, with a capacity-building phase from January to May 2026. The satellite layer is arriving over a ground network its own funders describe as fragmented.	ADVANCED

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	The United States Embassy states US\$7.3bn of commercial partnerships facilitated over eighteen months, of which the data-centre project is the largest. The embassy's own figure, carried as such, is US\$7.3bn of commercial partnerships facilitated in the country over the previous eighteen months, with Kobong the largest of them (statement). The embassy also launched an artificial-intelligence skills programme under the Sebatatso initiative in June 2026 (programme). No hyperscaler commitment, data-centre region or cloud agreement with a United States provider is recorded.	ADVANCED
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	Chinese engagement on file is a single financial route: renminbi settlement reaching the country through a commercial bank in July 2026. Standard Bank extended access to China's cross-border interbank payment system beyond South Africa to five markets including Lesotho, reported on 27 July 2026 (access). No Chinese vendor contract, memorandum, loan or infrastructure project is recorded for the country in this base, which makes the payment route the whole of the relationship on record.	ADVANCED
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments	European engagement on file is the digital birth registration programme run with the European Union and UNICEF since April 2025. The programme launched on 2 April 2025 with the European Union and UNICEF as partners (launch). No value, term or wider European digital engagement is recorded, and no European Union instrument covering the country's digital transformation is held.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments	Labour arrangements are concluded with Qatar, before cabinet for the Emirates and at an advanced stage with Saudi Arabia. 2026-02-05 — the Saudi ambassador reaffirmed an airport rehabilitation commitment while presenting credentials. 2026-05-27 — the minister separated concluded, cabinet-pending and advanced-stage bilateral labour arrangements across the Gulf states. 2026-06-05 — Lesotho pitched data-centre and multi-sector investment to Dubai Chambers, arguing from its water resources for cooling. The engagements on record are labour export and an investment pitch; no signed digital or data instrument with a Gulf state is held.	ADVANCED
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments	The memorandum with India of July 2025 named digital identity, a unified payment environment and once-only exchange as priorities, and nothing under it is on record. The memorandum was signed during the Indian minister of state's visit to Maseru on 29 July 2025, naming those three priorities for the year (memorandum). No deliverable, workstream or funding under it is on record a year later, though both the identity and the interoperability workstreams recorded elsewhere in this ledger cite it as their starting point.	NO CHANGE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National Cybersecurity Strategy	The text of the strategy the minister invoked at the LesComCSIRT launch, or an official statement of its adoption date, version and targets. The 2022 Cybersecurity Capacity Maturity Model review states Lesotho had no official national strategy.	not yet probed
National open data portal	A government open-data portal or published open-data policy for Lesotho, or an official statement that none exists.	2026-08-31
AI legislation or regulations	an AI Act, or regulations made under an existing statute, with a gazette reference	2026-08-31
National address register	a state address register or addressing standard with a coverage figure, or a ministerial statement that the private platform is the national one	2026-08-31

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-09-09
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/LSO/LSO-progress-2026-09-09.pdf
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0